

17. Project Closure



Major Tasks of Project

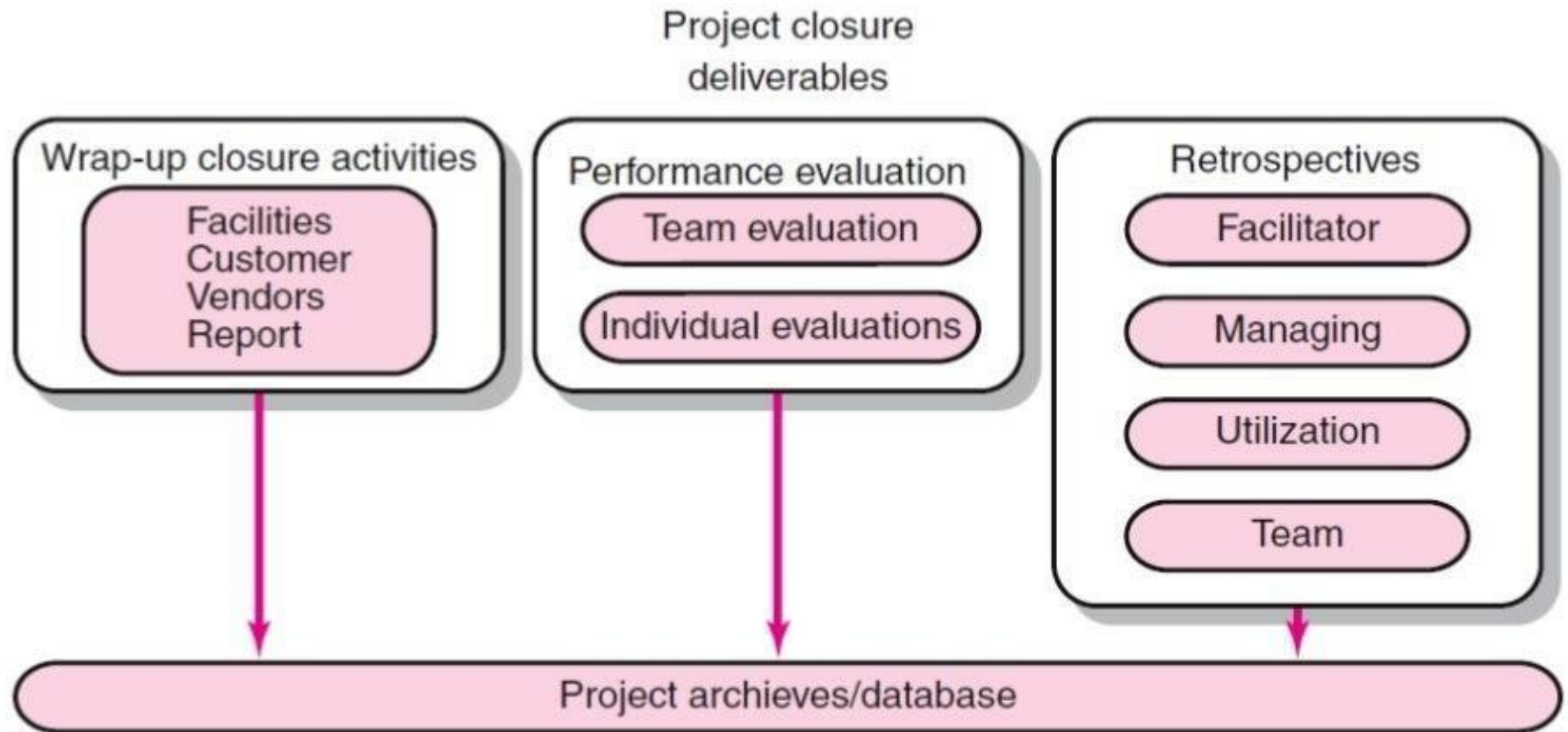
Closure

1. Evaluate if the project delivered the expected benefits to all stakeholders.
2. Assess what was done well and what contributed to successes.
 - Was the project managed well?
 - Was the customer satisfied?
3. Identify changes to improve the delivery of future projects.

Project Monitoring Activities

- A review of why the project was selected.
- A reassessment of the project's role in the organization's priorities.
- A check on the organizational culture to ensure it facilitates the type of project being implemented.
- An assessment of how well the project team is functioning; and if its is appropriately staffed.
- A check on external factors that might change where the project is heading or its importance.
- A review of all factors relevant to the project and to managing future projects.

Project Closure and Review Deliverables



Project Closure

- Types of Project Closure
 - Normal
 - Premature
 - Perpetual
 - Failed Project
 - Changed Priority
- Close-out Plan:
Questions to be Asked
 - What tasks are required to close the project?
 - Who will be responsible for these tasks?
 - When will closure begin and end?
 - How will the project be delivered?



Wrap-up Closure Checklist

Task	Completed? Yes/No
<i>Team</i>	
1 Has a schedule for reducing project staff been developed and accepted?	
2 Has staff been released or notified of new assignments?	
3 Have performance reviews for team members been conducted?	
4 Has staff been offered outplacement services and career counseling activities?	
<i>Vendors/contractors</i>	
5 Have performance reviews for all vendors been conducted?	
6 Have project accounts been finalized and all billing closed?	
<i>Customer/Users</i>	
7 Has the customer signed-off on the delivered product?	
8 Has an in-depth project review and evaluation interview with the customer been conducted?	
9 Have the users been interviewed to assess their satisfaction with the deliverables? With the project team? With vendors? With training? With support? With maintenance?	
<i>Equipment and facilities</i>	
10 Have project resources been transferred to other projects?	
11 Have rental or lease equipment agreements been closed out?	
12 Has the date for the closure review been set and stakeholders notified?	

Implementing Closedown

1. Getting delivery acceptance from the customer.
2. Shutting down resources and releasing to new uses.
3. Reassigning project team members.
4. Closing accounts and paying all bills.
5. Evaluating the project team, project team members, and the project manager.

Creating the Final Report

- Executive Summary
 - Project goals met/unmet
 - Stakeholder satisfaction with project
 - User reactions to quality of deliverables
- Analysis
 - Project mission and objective
 - Procedures and systems used
 - Organization resources used
- Recommendations
 - Technical improvements
 - Corrective actions
- Lessons Learned
 - Reminders
 - Retrospectives
- Appendix
 - Backup data
 - Critical information

Project Performance Evaluations

- Reasons for Poor-Quality Project Performance Evaluations:
 - Evaluations of individuals are left to supervisors of the team member's home department.
 - Typically measure team performance only on time, cost, and specifications.



Pre-Implementation Conditions: Team

- Are standards and goals for measuring performance clear, challenging, and attainable? Lead to positive consequences?
- Are responsibilities and performance standards known by all team members?
- Are team rewards adequate? Management believes teams are important?
- Is there a career path for successful project managers
- Does the team have discretionary authority to manage short-term difficulties?
- Is there a high level of trust within the organization culture?
- Are there criteria beyond time, cost, and specifications?

Sample Team Evaluation and Feedback Survey

	Disagree			Agree	
<i>Using the scale below, assess each statement.</i>					
1. The team shared a sense of common purpose, and each member was willing to work toward achieving project objectives.	1	2	3	4	5
2. Respect was shown for other points of view. Differences of opinion were encouraged and freely expressed.	1	2	3	4	5
3. All interaction among team members occurred in a comfortable, supportive atmosphere.	1	2	3	4	5

Conducting Performance Reviews

- Begin by asking the individual to evaluate his or her own performance.
- Avoid drawing comparisons with other team members; rather, assess the individual in terms of established standards and expectations.
- Focus criticism on specific behaviors rather than on the individual personally.
- Be consistent and fair in treatment of all team members.
- Treat the review as one point in an ongoing process.

Individual Performance Assessment

- Multirater appraisal (360-degree feedback)
 - Involves requesting feedback concerning team members' performance from all of the people that their work affects.
 - Project managers, area managers, peers, subordinates, and customers.



Retrospectives

- Lessons Learned

- An analysis carried out during and shortly after the project life cycle to capture positive and negative project learning—“what worked and what didn’t?”

- Goals of Retrospectives

- To reuse learned solutions
 - To stop repetitive mistakes



Retrospectives (cont'd)

- Barriers to Organizational Learning
 - Lack of post-project time for developing lessons
 - No post-project direction or support for teams
 - Lessons become blame sessions
 - Lessons are not applied in other locations
 - Organizational culture does not recognize value of learning



The Value of Retrospective Analyses

- Making Retrospectives Effective:
 - Use an independent facilitator to guide the project team through the analysis project activities.
 - Include a minimum of three in-process learning gates during the life project cycle.
 - Designate a team member as owner for each point in the retrospective.
 - Develop an easy-to-use learning repository to ensure future utilization of retrospective lessons.
 - Mandate use of retrospectives as part of the normal process for all projects.

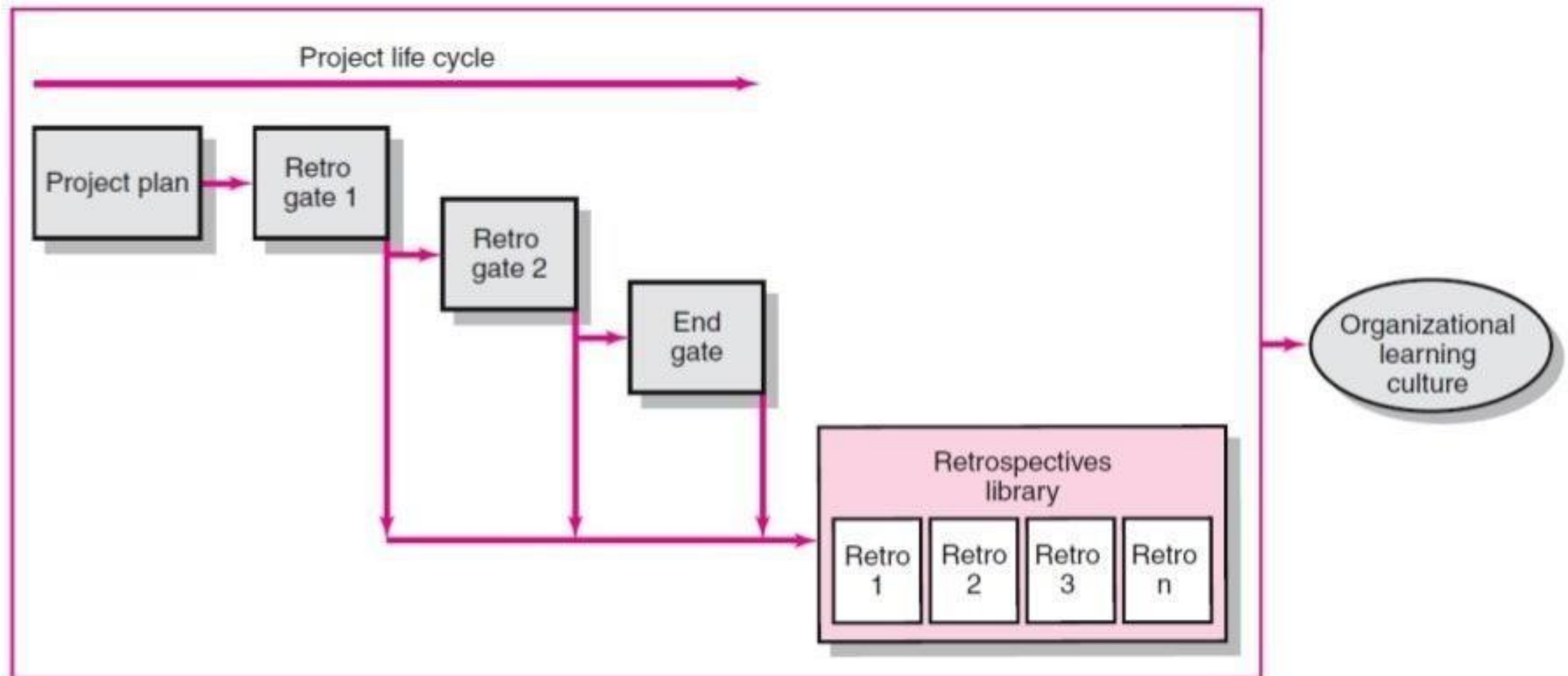
Characteristics of a Facilitator

1. No direct involvement or direct interest in the project.
2. Perceived as impartial and fair
3. Respect of senior management and other project stakeholders.
4. Willingness to listen.
5. Independence and authority to report results without fear of recriminations from special interests.
6. Perceived as having the best interests of the organization in making decisions.
7. Broad-based experience in the organization or industry.

Initiating the Retrospective Review

- Have automatic times or points when reviews will take place. Avoid surprises.
- Conduct reviews carefully and with sensitivity
- Review staff must independent from the project.
- Review reports need to be used and accessible.
- Reviews support organizational culture
- Project closures should be planned and orderly.
- Certain “core conditions” must be in place to support team and individual evaluation.
- Conduct individual and team evaluations separate from pay or merit reviews.

The Retrospectives Process



Conducting a Retrospective Analysis

- Initiation
- Data Collection and Analysis
- Reporting



Archiving Retrospectives

- Classifying of Projects:
 - Project type
 - Size
 - Staffing
 - Technology level
 - Strategic or support
 - Issues and problems
 - Project mission and objectives
 - Procedures and systems used
 - Organization resources used



Reference(s)

- † Erik W. Larson & Clifford F. Gray, *“Project Management: The Managerial Process”*, 7th Edition, Mc-Graw Hill Education.
- † Lucy C. Morse & Daniel L. Babcock, *“Managing Engineering and Technology”*, 6th Edition, Pearson.
- † John M. Nicholas & Herman Steyn, *“Project Management for Business, Engineering and Technology, Principles and practice”*, 3th Edition, ELSEVIER.
- † Harold Kerzner, *“Project Management, A System Approach to Planning, Scheduling & Controlling”*, 10th Edition, John Wiley & Sons, Inc, 2012,
ISBN: 978-0-470-27870-3.
- † Gerry Johnson & Kevin Scholes, *“Exploring Corporate Strategy”*, 8th Edition.
- † Related documents from open source, mainly internet.

Project Closeout Checklist

	Item	Status	Comments/Plan to Resolve
1	Have all the product or service deliverables been accepted by the customer?		
1.1	Are there contingencies or conditions related to the acceptance? If so, describe in the Comments.		
2	Has the project been evaluated against each performance goal established in the project performance plan?		
3	Has the actual cost of the project been tallied and compared to the approved cost baseline?		
3.1	Have all approved changes to the cost baseline been identified and their impact on the project documented?		
4	Have the actual milestone completion dates been compared to the approved schedule?		
4.1	Have all approved changes to the schedule baseline been identified and their impact on the project documented?		
5	Have all approved changes to the project scope been identified and their impact on the performance, cost, and schedule baselines documented?		

(Continued)